TEACHING IN HIGHER EDUCATION
2020, VOL. 25, NO. 6, 722–735
https://doi.org/10.1080/13562517.2020.1746263

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'Hurry up please, it's time!' A psychogeography of a decommissioned university campus

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ABSTRACT

This paper takes a soon-to-be disestablished satellite university campus as its site of enquiry. The campus has been an educational institution since the early twentieth century. Shortly it will be decommissioned, its future undetermined; at this moment in time it seems fitting to critically reflect on this place and the ideas and work of teaching that have shaped its material form. Using the methodology of an *attentive walk* from psychogeography, I attend to places and things on the campus which have furthered the work of teaching, allowing for moments of critical nostalgia. This involves looking backward and reflecting on the history of the site, with the critical aim to draw attention to limitations of contemporary hegemonic practices and discourses relating to time in the university, which prioritise its economic function (Adam 1998). Attending to everyday objects recognises the significance of ordinary materialities in teachers' working lives, present and past.

ARTICLE HISTORY
Received 11 November 2019
Accepted 19 March 2020

KEYWORDS
Space; time; campus; psychogeography; phenomenology

Introduction

In the poem 'The work of happiness' (1938–48/1974) May Sarton attends to the effect on place of long-term habits of thought: 'No one has heard a thought or listened to a mind' but 'where people have lived in inwardness, the air is charged with blessing and does bless'. Over a span of time, a benediction arising from the repeated work of the mind seeps into the fabric of a place, 'strikes its roots deep' into walls, floors and objects, so that in turn these things themselves nurture thought and 'the walls are kind' (Sarton 1938–48/1974, 66). In this paper I claim that something similar happens over time in places that are dedicated to the work of *teaching*. To examine this phenomenon, I engage in the psychogeography practice of an *attentive walk* around a higher education teaching site: a satellite campus in a large southern hemisphere university housing a faculty of education and social Work. This site has been designated for teaching for nearly one hundred years[1] and the work of education is deep in its material fabric.

In 2019 it was confirmed that this campus will be decommissioned, and the faculty will move to the main central campus into a collection of pre-existing decanted buildings. Centralisation of this kind is double edged. Although the move will bring the faculty into the

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heart of the university it will also engender the dismantling of an existing, purpose-built-for-education campus; while enhancing opportunities for cross-discipline activity it also enacts a consolidation of sites and buildings justified, like the dismantling of small local schools and closure of educational institutions at the 'neighbourhood level' (Gulson and Symes 2007, 106), on the grounds of efficiencies and economies of scale. The process, in keeping with the austerity discourse that pervades contemporary education, has the additional justification that some disciplines (like the arts and education) are expensive or offer poor returns in financial terms, so merit reduced access to space designed for specific teaching activities.[2]

While the future use of the site is undetermined, classrooms and other places used for furthering the work of teaching will likely be destroyed, and the objects within them removed (and in some cases treasured) or also destroyed. This moment in time – on the cusp of the faculty's transfer and the site's disestablishment – is opportune to critically reflect on this place and the ideas, practices and work of teaching that have shaped and infused its material form.[3] It is likely there will be a range of responses to the demolition of the site and its buildings (from anger and mourning to excitement), but hopefully there will also be reflection on the ideas, values and pedagogical aims that underpinned its material form, and the important-yet-everyday work of education that went on inside its buildings.

With that hope in mind, this article engages in deliberate acts of critical nostalgia (Bonnett 2015). Critical nostalgia involves reflecting on the history of a site which embraces the *nostalgic* dimension of looking backward in time, and a lost (or soon-to-be lost) place (Hutcheon and Valdés 1998–2000), with the *critical* aim to draw attention to the limitations of contemporary hegemonic practices and discourses (Bonnett 2015). In broad terms these can be characterised, according to Adam (1998, 2004), as preoccupied with the 'compression of time' and 'the valorisation of speed in a social system that relates to time on an economic basis' (Adam 1998, 3). In the higher education context, time is shaped by these discourses, or normative temporal frameworks (Bennett and Burke 2018), to the extent that practices relating to teaching and research valorise efficiencies and competition over (all?) other goals, as part of a fixation with finance (Peters 2015). Consequently, there is a tendency to overlook the value of ordinary day-to-day practices of teaching – except when framed in competitive terms or justified as excellent (Readings 1996). Critical nostalgia, like psychogeography, has a political aim to insist on the humanity of places, valuing everyday activities that go on in them; to reinscribe 'the unspoken histories and experiences of a place into its official discourse'; and to value 'emotional and sensory experiences of a particular location' that do not feature in 'big plans' or official histories (Weeks and Byrne 2014, n.p.).

Time in the university

By engaging in critical nostalgia this article also draws attention to the impact of changing conceptions of time in the university. As Felt (2016) and Berg and Seeber (2016) point out, while much has been written on the corporatisation of universities, the impact on (or relationship to) time is relatively underexplored. Berg and Seeber (2016) consider, after Readings (1996), how the trend to make universities more like businesses 'has led to standardised learning and a sense of urgency' – it has 'sped up the clock' (Berg and Seeber

2016, 8). Whereas the 'growth in peace' of thought that Sarton describes (and values) is *slow*, the governing temporal modality in twenty-first century higher education is *fast* (Peters 2015). This impacts the nature of academic work, including teaching practices, strips back 'time to think' (Felt 2016, 2) and contributes to a broader loss of value in anything that takes time. Recent work on slow academia (Berg and Seeber 2016) reminds us that there are certain things that can only happen over a sustained period: the development of flavour in cooking, the growth of the giant kauri tree, the education of a human.

Arguments *for* deceleration or slowness in academia are partly to do with fostering an ontological orientation in students and academics, with creating and sustaining identity and belonging (Felt 2016, 2) coupled with a sense of *being in a time and place*. Black (2016) writes about being in academic time, musing on the changing seasons to reflect on 'the rhythm and content of an intellectual vocation' (2). My aim is closer to psychogeography's commitment to 'inscribe slowness onto a place' (Weeks and Byrne 2014), to *notice* and recognise the lived history that formed this site of tertiary-level teaching, including the ideas, values and activities that have shaped and been shaped by it over time. This is partially motivated by conservation ('It is harder to dispose of anything,' writes MacFarlane (2005a), once one has paid attention to its details' (34)) but it has another aim. By attending to the present and its relationship to the past we are also *in time* as we become aware of the processes of growth, change and disintegration.

The ways that humans experience and comprehend being in time are considered by Adam (2004), in her account of time theories. From Kant, Adam writes, philosophy and social theory inherited the idea that time is both 'empirically real and transcendentally ideal'. Although time 'precedes experience and perception', cannot be seen, and is therefore evidence of our capacity for reason, there is also no way of comprehending it other than through its impact on things – 'no way of knowing the *noumenon,* the thing itself, beyond the way it appears to us as *phenomenon*' (Adam 2004, 34–5). Things *reveal* time. Although Hegel concurred with Kant that the idea of time was eternal, his contribution to time theories was to reconceptualise time as 'immanent, as internal to and constitutive of living and social systems' (Adam 2004, 36). Time is *constituted by* things. These two ideas – that we can only reflect on time (in the university) through its impact *on* phenomenon and that time (in the university) is created *by* phenomenon – are traced in this article through the theoretical frame of psychogeography.

Theoretical framework: psychogeography and phenomenology

Psychogeography, according to Bonnett (2015), 'was born with a sense of loss for the city'. As Paris was subject to widespread demolition during a period of modernisation, the first psychogeographers, the Situationists, feared that there would be homogenisation of social life and loss of 'authentic attachments and political memories' with the demolition of ancient sites. The Situationists aimed to draw attention to ways that places are a source of memory and identity, rather than to 'retreat from time' or the processes of change (Bonnett 2015, 34), just as *critical* nostalgia seeks to avoid nostalgia's longing to reinstate a past time-place, whilst sharing its value for attachment and memory. The Situationists resembled the early twentieth century radical historians who walked England (Guldi 2011) aiming to research the disappearing social life of rural, working class communities through an exploration of landscape and environment. What these historians and

psychogeographers share is an epistemology that foregrounds *place* and the 'everyday environment' as a source of knowing about the past (Guldi 2011, 70).

The Situationists drew attention to the eradication of local, community-oriented, distinctive, heterogenous sites in Paris with history and character, and their replacement with spatial and material uniformity, 'corporate identities and urban landscapes' (Bonnett 2015, 35). There are obvious parallels with universities, which tend to impose a corporate identity or brand (Temple 2014) on built environments. While universities do sometimes seek to protect old buildings, such preservation is often limited to those deemed 'heritage' which fit *with* a corporate identity – because the buildings represent the institution's foundation or ideas about university education still valued. Sites and buildings that are heterogenous, with distinct and characterful history, are more endangered. In psychogeography, a site is not simply of interest because it is heritage but because it is where ordinary people lived and worked, and to which they have formed memories and attachments *over time*. That worth gradually accrues in a place of education was the understanding of the principal of the former college, Duncan Rae, who responded to an early amalgamation attempt: 'we are not prepared tamely to yield up what we have patiently built up over the years' (Shaw 2006, 82).

It is not solely 'authentic attachment' but also 'political memory' that psychogeography foregrounds. Paying attention to place involves reflecting on ideas that underpin its physical environment – the idea being that the organisation of space is a 'symptom' of political culture (Guldi 2011, 71). This campus reveals a changing political culture, the values underlying its structures are multiple rather than singular (Locke 2015), however, the educational and political ideals of the early to mid-twentieth century are strongly reflected in the physical environment, its flora and open fields, loosely connected buildings and openness to the community. These ideals were expressed in 1937, at the opening of a new hall on the campus by the Minister of Education Peter Fraser (later Prime Minister), in terms of the vital role of teachers in creating equal opportunity in society and the importance of education to democracy and social reconstruction (Shaw 2006). Schools and universities in the mid-twentieth century were shaped by an idea – though not the only idea – that they functioned as *social institutions* (Barnett 2013, 35), connected to local communities as well as to the project of social democracy.

In addition to psychogeography, and its attention to political memory, this article draws on phenomenology in reflecting on the lived dimensions of higher education. Ordinary places and things are also the university – seats we sit in, boards we write on, stairs we climb, books or tablets we hold – and shape the work of our minds. In phenomenology, Merleau-Ponty writes, 'there is no inner man, man is in the world'. Whereas Kant '*detached* the subject, or consciousness', in phenomenology, thought and truth is of the world (Merleau-Ponty 1962/2000, xi, ix). This understanding of phenomena has implications for conceptions of *time*. According to Adam's (2004) reading of Husserl, time is in the external realm of objects *and* the internal world of experience. Like Hegel, Husserl considers an object in relation to time: each always refers *ahead and back*. A perception of the present is entwined with a sense of what *has been*, Husserl's concept of 'retention', and what *will be*, or 'protention' (Adam 2004, 56–7). If we pay attention to our perception of phenomena, we become more aware of time *and* build our capacity to imagine a future. However, without a consciousness of what has been, 'we would not know what we had been saying so far', or where this could lead in future (Adam 2004, 57).

Methodology

Informed by psychogeography and phenomenology, and with the aim of engaging in critical nostalgia, I undertook an *attentive walk* through the campus in the winter of 2019. According to DeBord, psychogeography involves the 'study of the specific effects of the geographical environment, consciously organized or not, on the emotions and behaviours of individuals' (cited in Coverley 2006). Psychogeography is *both* to do with 'geography' (place) and 'psychology' (meanings of place). It allows for and values personal and 'small scale' experiences of place *and* attends to ways that specific things or places can represent aspects of communal identity as mnemonics or 'anchors for historical traditions' (Bonnett 2015, 5–6). As a methodology it has potential to elucidate the effects of higher educational sites on academics and students.

Although I had walked the same paths before, this time I walked with intention and attention, taking photographs and making notes of objects and places and the effects of processes of time – stairs that once lead to a building now demolished; an enormous pile of tree clippings; flowering bulbs; a view toward a dormant volcano. MacFarlane (2005b) describes the method of psychogeography as beginning with the walk:

> Record the experiences as you go, in whatever medium you favour: film, photograph, manuscript, tape. Catch the textual run-off of the streets: the graffiti, the branded litter, the snatches of conversation. Catch the sign. Log the data stream. Be alert to the happenstance of metaphors, watch for visual rhymes, coincidences, analogies, family resemblances, the changing moods of the street. (MacFarlane 2005b, 3)

At first, I used photographs and notes mainly to sustain alertness – to notice that I was walking past some objects, like a set of redundant pigeon-holes, and to pause and look more carefully, attending to the litter inside. Historians 'who walked' claimed that 'attention, not expertise' is important for interpreting landscape (Guldi 2011, 69). I also took notes on the process, including the discomfort of pausing while others walk by me, and of resisting the urge to hurry and get back to my office. Other meanings of notes and images emerge later (Pyyry 2019) enabling a researcher to draw out those 'visual rhymes, coincidences, analogies' that MacFarlane (2005b, 3) identifies.

This methodology has congruence with Pyyry's (2019) 'hanging-out-knowing', a research methodology that also draws on psychogeography, and the Situationist practice of the *dérive* (drifting),[4] which directs attention to 'passing moments and banal details' while walking in an urban environment (315). Pyyry (2015, 2016) was inspired to attempt the practice after researching with youth.

> While hanging out, young people form creative momentary engagements with their urban landscape while seemingly doing nothing noteworthy. It is from this characteristically non-instrumental involvement that spatial-embodied reflection about one's place in the world emerges. (Pyyry 2019, 316)

This mode is seemingly *time-wasting* in that time is given over to it for no real purpose other than to hang out, yet it is vital to forming attachment to place. As part of the method of 'hanging-out-knowing' Pyyry also conducted a photo-walk – taking photographs of 'encounters that somehow move the researcher' while walking in the city, pausing for notetaking and reading. The photographs were directed at 'fleeting and often obvious elements of the everyday' which elicited a reaction (Pyyry 2019, 317–8).

Walking is a time for and mode of thinking for me, which is why psychogeography resonates as research methodology. A limitation is that it does *take time*, which can be in short supply for the contemporary researcher, or the busy parent, carer or student juggling multiple responsibilities. 'I like walking because it is slow, and I suspect that the mind, like the feet, works at about three miles an hour', writes Solnit. 'If this is so, then modern life is moving faster than the speed of thought, or thoughtfulness' (Solnit 2014, 10). Walking with deliberate attention *as methodology* reduces speed further – requiring pauses to observe, note and reflect on phenomena. Yet it is a process that rewards by contributing to re-cognition (Pyyry 2019) and defamiliarisation (Cox, Herrick, and Keating 2012) of a place, enabling critical perspectives to emerge. Walking between different places in the university and taking photographs enabled Cox, Herrick, and Keating (2012) to engage a research methodology which denaturalised the 'fabric of the environment' whilst also tracing 'links to wider institutional processes and structures' in the university (697). Like the walk in psychogeography, their methodology links the spaces of the university (its geography) to the habitual lived and experienced places of work, including teaching spaces, of individuals (the psychology).

As a methodology informed by psychogeography, but also phenomenology and history, the walk allows for recognition of the significance, agency, or immanence of ordinary materialities in teachers' working lives, present and past. Like the methodology of material and visual historians of education (Lawn and Grosvenor 2001; Burke 2018), it recognises the value of *things* in revealing everyday educational experiences, past and present.

> History objects … are memory triggers. Telling stories about objects can enable teachers to explain to an outsider the nature of their work culture, to make connections between events of yesterday and today, and to locate themselves in history. Stories about objects can provide historians with fragmentary episodes of experience that can be added to material generated by more traditional methodological approaches in the construction of accounts of teacher work. (Lawn and Grosvenor 2001, 126)

Encounters with disused teaching-related objects or 'debris of history' can help researchers 'bring the past into the present and thereby generate new insights about past teacher lives, working practices and cultures' (Lawn and Grosvenor 2001, 127). This chimes with my ethical and critical aim to acknowledge the *meaningfulness of things* around this campus that are going to be destroyed or removed but which once had a use and meaning in the ordinary work of teaching and thought. Historians, as Guldi (2011) writes, encourage us to 'keep looking' and see that history is 'around us all the time, in the ever-present archive of the built environment' (75). The photographs discussed below are taken of things I returned to because they moved me – but also because they are part of that archive, (Pyyry 2019), they say something about the day to day ordinary/meaningful work of teaching in this place, and they are material things (phenomenon) in which time (the noumenon) is immanent.

Below is a linked analysis of three sites photographed during the walk that reflects on family resemblances relating to time of places and objects in this university campus.

Site one: the gym

I worked at the campus several years before entering the teaching spaces of the gym, dance room or drama studio. When I did it was as a student taking yoga classes organised by the

university to foster staff well-being. I am critical of these (small, rather than systemic) attempts to mitigate the impact of fast academia (Peters 2015; Berg and Seeber 2016) yet also grateful for them. For one thing, the spaces are beautiful. Each has a wooden floor worn and marked by decades of use by feet leaping, dancing, standing still. Architects designing educational institutions in the 1950s and 1960s, according to Burke, attended to 'qualities of wood used for hall floors where it was intended that bare feet would be essential in the full experience of the movement' (Burke 2018, 46). The feeling was to do with promoting a sense of 'being alive', she writes, drawing on Tim Ingold. Each of the rooms are oriented to the sun, so that in the middle of the day, when my usually upright body is laid out stretching, the wood is often warm and golden (when there is no sun, they are cold and less welcoming).

The gym and drama studio are spaces that reflect a mid-twentieth century goal of educating teachers according to the principles of new education and education for democracy – the idea being that a child would have little use for dictators growing up happy and active, dancing like a butterfly on a warm wooden floor. According to Burke, 'enthusiasm for dance and movement' in post-war primary education in Britain and the Commonwealth 'mirrored the rise and fall of enthusiasm for child-centred education and progressive approaches' (Burke 2018, 42). The core curriculum introduced into Aotearoa New Zealand by the Labour Government in the mid-1940s included the arts, drama, science and physical education. The gym and the drama studio were purpose-built for intending teachers to develop knowledge and skill in these subject areas *and* themselves know the 'full experience' of 'being alive' through movement.

The blackboard (Image 1) shows layers of markings partially erased: names, teams, a faint parabola. (Hear the stamp of feet, laughter, shouts, frustration and instruction.) Below the board is a small hatch, a cubby for a duster and chalk, or pens, accommodating



Image 1. Site one.

different objects according to changing teaching practices. I think of Husserl's retentions and protentions, and Whitehead's idea of 'actual occasions' which, according to Adam (2004, 59), unify ephemerality and endurance, the static and dynamic. Actual occasions are not singular moments but connect to other occasions, past and future. The walls have strips of tape that used to hold signs; worn markings on the floor that define court boundaries. It has low benches, designed for children's legs, around the edges, and a high viewing balcony accessible via a curved metal stair. It has storerooms for equipment and more hatches, now empty, for telephones. I visit these hatches often as they enchant me. Each is a small space designed and built into the wall in modernist style, providing a home for a thing. Mid-century New Zealand architect Plishke (1947) suggested an abundance of built-in storerooms so that gymnasiums could be communal, allowing for co-operation and shared use. Bachelard (1994) writes of how drawers, filing cabinets and wardrobes are objects that enable organisation and prevent, by corralling things into a small space, disorder and chaos in the larger space. They are banal, unimportant, miraculous and comforting. I imagine tucking something in there, if I taught in this room.

Site two: tiled passageway

Between the gym and the drama studio is a tiled passageway. It connects to the corridor and stair well that I come down every Thursday for yoga, and it connects to two outside doors: one leads to an early childhood centre and the other to a path that leads the children from the neighbouring intermediate school to the gym. There is no fence between the campus and the school, just open fields, as the school uses the gym and pool, in keeping with the mid-century social democratic principle *and* practice of 'organic co-ordination and relationship among the different groups that make up our society' (Plishke 1947, 92). When I started here, after being on the city campus, I was struck by the presence of children. So simple a thing, in a day working at a university faculty of education and social work, to see a child, yet it seemed tremendous, like the sighting of a rare bird (which also happens). Our state education system has several tiers: early childhood, the compulsory levels (primary, intermediate and secondary), and tertiary education. In the 1930s the Director of Education spoke of the educational life cycle of the child, and the importance of enabling ease of movement between levels to encourage children to go on to further education, as befit a social democracy. Despite this aim, schools and universities are usually separate. Yet this campus traverses all three tiers of education, from early childhood to university-level, in keeping with its place in the educational life cycle.

The photograph (Image 2) shows footprints and leaves against brown tiles, evidence of winter rain and wind outside, of feet traversing to the gym. The brown and earthy materials are not a corporate look, and some colleagues are scathing about the 1970s vibe of this part of the campus. It hasn't been touched in a long time. The tiles are solid, unlike the wet footprints and leaf which, when I come back later, are gone – dried up and blown away. Yet the tiles are ephemeral too – as the campus is. To pay attention is to be aware of time future, the passing of things.

The passageway is a place I notice stopping. Colleagues on their way to yoga called me out on it – what are you looking at, what are you doing there? My meandering is not appropriate for our time, which is intolerant of what Solnit (2014) terms 'time inbetween' or



Image 2. Site two.

> the time of walking to or from a place, of meandering, of running errands. This time has been deplored as a waste, reduced … . The very ability to appreciate this uncluttered time, the uses of the useless, often seems to be evaporating (Solnit 2014, xiii).

The distance of this site from the rest of the university creates more of these 'inbetween' moments as students and staff travel between campuses. It will be so good, we are told, no more wasting time travelling between the campus and the city! I have never seen it as wasted time. It is time to walk, to read on the bus, to think, be outside. Yet I know others perceive it this way, so I *do* often rush, or get anxious if the bus is late or if there are groups of schoolchildren in my way, meandering, as I hurry to get somewhere.

When we move to the city campus, we will also lose our distinctive timetable, which has classes start around the half hour, for the city campus timetable which starts and ends classes on the hour. The times and routines that we currently operate on are partly to do with allowing for the lives of our students, some of whom come from schools, and partly for teaching staff who may be travelling from the city campus and need this time in-between. There has also been some pride, differentiation, that our class times are *not* those of 'the mothership' with which we will soon have to fit.

Site three: N block pigeon-holes

I took photographs of this set of pigeon-holes (Image 3) on the walk, then went back to notice what was *inside* them – thinking about litter and detritus (MacFarlane 2005b). I found: a dry leaf, a laminated arrow, 2 pages of writing in Chinese, a biscuit wrapper, an old computer cord, another wrapper, a cobweb, and a lot of old flyers for something called *Velocity 2017*. These (very dusty) flyers elicited a stirring of irritation and dismissal. I dislike terms like 'Velocity' 'Vector' and 'Spark' which saturate the language of university



Image 3. Site three.

advertising. The campaign logo for our university advertisements is 'Never stop' with a dashing speed-of-light image used in the institution's branding as a visual meme – an injunction to keep on going until you drop? Not a healthy message to send our students and staff (thank goodness for yoga!).

What is it that the flyer advertises? It seems to be inviting ideas for a university entrepreneurial programme – at least I think so, the basic information is about all I could take in before my eyes and mind glazed over. I put the flyer back, wiping my fingers on my clothes. Days later I noticed my brain has been turning over *velocity* so I looked it up. A quick google search confirmed its meaning: the speed of something in a given direction. Synonyms are speed, pace, rate, tempo, momentum, impetus. In economics, it means the rate at which money changes hands within an economy – the velocity of circulation. One site tells me it is the rate of change of an object's position with respect to a frame of reference and is a function of time.

I read on. The kinetic energy of a moving object is dependent on its velocity, apparently. The way to calculate the velocity of a projectile (in a straight line) is $\boldsymbol{r = d / t}$ if r = the rate of speed or velocity, d = the distance moved, t = the time it takes the object to complete the movement. Why is this useful? According to another site, knowing the velocity of something enables you to determine *how quickly an object will arrive at its destination from a given location*, to create timetables or plan journeys. I'm tired-and-wired from weeks of teaching and my mind is making unusual connections, so I decide to try and calculate the velocity of the campus' 'movements' to predict the faculty's time of 'arrival' at the next phase of its existence. The first period of time from the decision to establish a training college on the site (1922) to becoming a faculty in the university (2004) was 82 years, so the rate of travel (velocity) was reasonably slow: r = distance [Training College to University campus] / speed [82 years]. The second phase from 2004 (when it joined the university) to

2020 (planned removal to city campus) occurred at a faster velocity: r = distance [satellite campus to main university] / speed [16 years]. If the velocity increases at the same rate – if the faculty continues to change at its current rate of speed – we should be heading for whatever is next (dispersal, absorption into another faculty, privatisation of teacher training) in just a few years. (It's at that point I remembered the faded parabola in the gym showing the path of a projectile under the influence of gravity).

Whitehead's occasions, according to Adam (2004), are to do with 'being in tune with and "feeling" certain patterns' in processes of change; he developed the concept of prehension to describe this feeling (60). A few days later I re-issue *Universities in the flux of time* and while travelling home on the bus flick through the chapter by Peters (2015). According to Peters, speed and velocity are *the* concepts of the 'techno-epistemological epoch' that has wrought 'a deep transformation of economy, society and the university'. In the current era, speed and fast knowledge are of the essence with 'significant consequences … for learning, education and culture' (Peters 2015, 11, 14). An encounter with a discarded *Velocity 2017* flyer speaks, in a sickening instant, of this transformation.

My stop at the pigeon-holes attracted notice from passers-by. Reading of Pyyry's (2019) 'hanging-out-knowing', or Solnit's (2014) meandering, recalls my sense, while hovering in various corridors, of being uncomfortable because I made time to stop when I should be hurrying past, as everyone else was, going somewhere to do something more obviously purposeful. Through 'routine daily practices, people take part in the re-production of the dominant urban rules of behaviour', writes Pyyry (2019, 317). Stopping, in that spot, used to be an accepted behaviour (to check a pigeon-hole), but now is no longer a routine daily practice for students or staff. Pigeon-holes were a vital means of communication between teaching staff when I started as a tutor in the mid-1990s. All staff teaching on a course would receive class lists, lecture outlines or lecture readings (sometimes collated) via the pigeon-holes, usually located 'inbetween' zones (Solnit 2014). (A colleague once distributed to every cubby hole, in a state of mania or insight, a thick treatise on the fourth dimension.) Communication of this kind has been replaced by email, so we don't hang about in corridors anymore – it is not a legitimate activity in the contemporary university, although it is acceptable to spend hours dealing with email in offices, or on our own time. The technology integrated into everyday university life has changed 'our connection with others and other spaces' according to Bennett and Burke (2018, 7). The pigeon-holes are a psychogeographer's mnemonic (Bonnett 2015) that speak of older ordinary routines and other structures of time in the university (Adam 2004; Felt 2016).

Pigeon-holes are also a unit of space, like the hatch in the gym, designed to enable order in university communication practices. (This set of pigeon-holes is in a large stairwell atrium which gives me vertigo when I look up.) Time, like space, is structured into small parts to bring order to what is potentially boundless. Abstract time or clock time is, according to Adam, an order 'imposed on nature … by a system of categories' and it is a social answer 'to the rhythms and uncertainties of the cosmos, the living world and the body' (2004, 34; 121). As Adam (2004) argues, time is subject to *control* in industrial societies – to 'impose an invariable beat on the variable rhythmicity of life' (146) – and the *compression* of time in universities (Felt 2016) is one form of control. Yet it would seem, as Adam suggests, that we have reached a point where 'time has been compressed to its limit; space is eliminated in the process' (2004, 146). As information is instantaneous, pigeon-holes are redundant, replaced by nonexistent 'in-boxes' which receive immediate

messages. Dealing with these can seem to be what work consists of in the contemporary university – yet there is often scant time allocated for this work in academic workload schedules and timetables. Instantaneity is not *orderly* – it is chaotic. This is Adam's point: through the compression of time, we have lost not only space but also *control of time* as 'instantaneity and simultaneity' have 'no place' in the 'world that we as bodies inhabit' (Adam 2004, 146). No place for a body, paused in its trajectory, peering into the dark interior of a pigeon-hole.

Conclusion

The material world of *phenomenon* is in time. Noticing the environment of the university means being in time – aware of past, present and future. This old, worn campus and its detritus of the past are reminders that the current mode of university life, the ways that time is structured and our routines, are not for *all time*. The set of pigeon-holes that was once a means of organising and facilitating communication amongst teaching staff and students is now a place to dump unread flyers and disused technologies – what will our inboxes be in the future? A recent article in the *New Yorker* suggests that the routines of our era are just a phase, a 'moment in workplace history' when 'caught up in the promise of synchronicity, we frantically checked our in-boxes every four minutes' (Newport 2019, n.p.). It too shall pass. Being aware of what has been and will be, the retention and protention of Husserl, is one reason ordinary objects have meaning and value. If time is immanent in things, if phenomenon constitute time, or reveal time as *noumenon,* then these old things, the detritus, speak and remind of the possibility of *slow time* in the university. Objects and places, if we attend to them, tell us that there were once other ways of thinking about time-space in the university, other ways of working with texts and information which was not instantaneous or compressed, but in rhythm with bodies.

In the 1990s Readings (1996), with amazing prehension, wrote of how 'time to completion' is 'presented as the universal criterion of quality and efficiency in education' (127–8). The moment of this faculty's arrival in its next phase is fast approaching – its velocity increasing at pace. The derelict state of the campus is one justification for the faculty's removal and its demolition – as it has been for social housing, libraries and schools which have been neglected, allowed to become run-down. Yet there is also *history* in this campus – it is an 'ever-present archive' of education. While it is fruitless to wish we would not 'tamely yield up' what has been built here over many years, through the work of thought and teaching, I hope we do not *at least* forgo the opportunity that the present time affords for recognising, with gratitude, its many blessings, the kindness of its walls, and the ideas, values and teaching practices deep in its material form.

Notes

1. According to Shaw (2006), the land was designated for a new teacher's college in 1922, at which time it was a 'gorse-covered reserve and a gravel pit'. Plans were made for a building in 1923 and the foundation stone laid in 1925. The *Auckland Star* reported that the new college 'symbolises the belief that is placed in schools' (Shaw 2006, 71–3).
2. Proposals to combine the university and teacher's college in earlier decades did not go ahead because of concerns that the college would grapple with having lower status than 'academic'

subjects, and because it would lose carefully designed spaces for teaching art and physical education (Shaw 2006, 84).

3. Other moments of change have also inspired reflections on the site. In 2015 Locke wrote of the 'changing materialities' of the campus and outlined the influence of 1970s ideas and discourses about education and social change. There was a 'palpable feeling of an emerging brave new world in education, an excitement and sense of anticipation' that ran 'through the buildings … their curved turrets and glassed enclosures' (Locke 2015, 601).
4. DeBord writes that in a *dérive* 'one or more persons during a certain period of time drop their usual motives for movement and action, their relations, their work and leisure activities, and let themselves be drawn by the attractions of the terrain and the encounters they find there.' (cited in Solnit 2014, 212).

Disclosure statement

No potential conflict of interest was reported by the author(s).

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